ARDEN OFFICE OF TOURISM — ANNUAL REPORT

Most recent completed year

VISITATION

Arden received 15 million visitors, an increase of 6.8 per cent. Overnight visitation to the offshore islands rose 5.7 per cent. Average party size was 2.5 and average length of stay 3.2 nights.

RECEIPTS AND EMPLOYMENT

Direct visitor spending was $7,494 million. The sector supported 89,264 jobs. Occupancy across the coastal counties averaged 68.1 per cent, and 83.4 per cent in the peak eight weeks.

MARKETING

The Office placed campaigns in 12 metropolitan markets. Cost per incremental visitor party was estimated at $25.6.

OUTLOOK

The Office notes that two of the last five seasons were disrupted by storm damage to coastal accommodation and access roads, and that recovery of island visitation after each event took a full season.

Statistical annexes available from the Office.